Be undeniably Yourself

Live off-leash



Remember Who you Are

Never Compromise

Question yourself

Be Cringe

Be free

OLDER ISSUES



THE CCC

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They're spying on me

Tracking every cent I earn

Following me through alleys

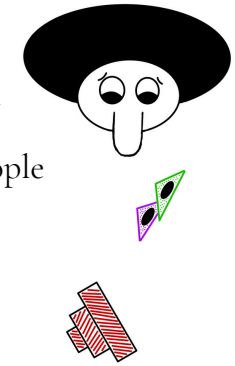
Listening through my smart fridge

Watching me stare *blankly* at a wall

What a waste of resources

Why not just approach me?

I want someone to talk to anyways

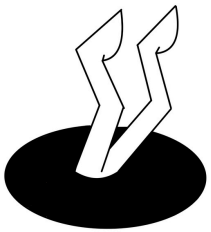


I'm being haunted by a beautiful ghost

I see it everyday – sometimes in other people

A year ago, this ghost was born

Now they won't let me feel alone



I hope to free my soul from this anchor

I hope to become a duppy conqueror

I often ask life: "are you serious?"

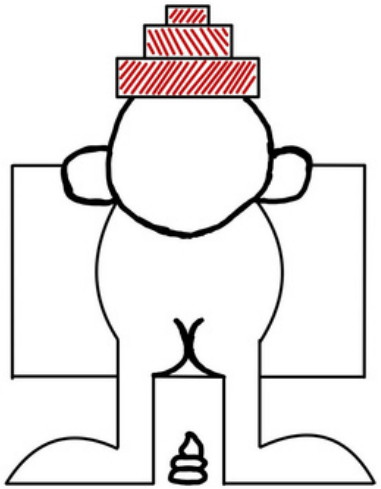
It keeps responding: "yes, I'm **serious**."

I wonder what took away its humor

You can try to predict it

Your version makes perfect sense

Yet life always turns out absurd



There is nothing more visually and morally appalling than seeing an AI-generated flyer in higher education. When talented students are spending thousands of dollars a year for their degree, eager for work-transferable experience, and campus departments pay for a premium Canva subscription, why is the opportunity to build valuable professional material erased by resorting to AI? Do you really hate our future leaders that much? If you are a professional staff member working in student affairs reading this, I strongly urge you to:

1. Encourage your staff to design original marketing material that's not fully AI-generated
2. Consider student artists when looking for talent. I promise you there are talented artists in every major.

Sincerely,
"the network"



CAN'T be Trusted

One night in our first Fall term, my first year roommates and I came up with the idea to pass notes under our suitemates' doors with our names and contact information so we could make new friends. We met Esme and Farah, but by the second week, Esme and Farah suddenly stopped talking to us. It all started when Ashley told Esme to "take a chill pill" after she complained that we were too loud now that school started. Friendships come and go, especially in college. We ended up hanging out with their roommate, Sophia, instead. We eventually befriended Lucas, who lived in the suite across from us, and Mike, who was Ashley's friend from high school. We all spent almost every night together, and it lasted for the rest of the quarter. Everything felt natural, so I trusted them quickly. Too quickly. I started sharing personal parts of my life, things people normally would not tell people unless they have known them for a long time. I could not help myself from oversharing because we were too comfortable. It felt like I had found my people.

I told them I liked Lucas and it immediately became complicated. I was told not to inform Sam about this due to the fact that she also liked him. Even though Lucas did not reciprocate the feelings, it created tension in the group. When Lucas and I started seeing each other, we kept it a secret at first. It felt exciting for a bit, but it was stressful hiding it from everybody else. Eventually, I decided to tell Sam. It felt like the right thing to do. I was so nervous, I couldn't eat. I watched her eat her eggs while I barely touched mine. Before I really revealed much, she already knew where it was headed. "You like him, huh?" Sam asked me. She then reassured me that everything was fine and that she was "chill" about it. She didn't seem upset, and for a moment, I believed her. However, over time, she began to make comments about me and post them online. A person I trusted was turning against me.

Things got worse when I introduced my best friend from high school, Precious, to the group. Everyone was so interested in who this "Precious" was since I talked about her all the time. When I posted about her on Instagram for her birthday, they started investigating her account, asking questions about how we met and what we were like in high school. I told them a sad story about how some boys from our high school tried to vote for a girl on the homecoming court as a joke, telling people to vote for her so they could pull a "Carrie" on her. It was sick. They thought I was talking about Precious, although I was talking about another girl. Somehow, the story got twisted, and Sophia ended up telling Precious that I was talking badly about her.

There was already tension building with this friend group by the second quarter. Sophia and Lucas never really got along, and I often felt stuck in the middle between their arguments. Sophia was one of my closest friends and Lucas was my boyfriend. Whose side do I choose? One day during our online class, our professor played "song of the day," and students were commenting in the chat. Lucas made a joke by mentioning Sophia in the chat, which said, "Sophia thought the song was fire." He didn't mean anything by it, but it clearly embarrassed her. She calls him out in the chat, which had over 400 students. It was so uncomfortable, I felt secondhand embarrassment. Sophia expected me to take her side. I understood why she might have been annoyed, but I also felt like she went too far by calling him out publicly. I didn't want to choose between my friend and my boyfriend.

I turned to Sam to talk about the situation. "I just don't know what to do," I told her. I confessed how I felt stuck in the middle and, no matter what I did, someone's always upset. As I kept talking, I could feel tears building up, but I didn't stop. I told her how confused I was about Sophia. I told her everything was falling apart in my life. I even shared my thoughts about Sophia's situation with Sheena—how Sophia thought Sheena was excluding her from hangouts, but Sheena was just caught up in making new friends. I explained to Sam that it's not easy to approach Sophia in an argument because she holds grudges, like the one she holds one against Sheena. Sam sat there, nodding, seeming to understand me, which made it easier to overshare without second guessing myself. I just needed someone to listen. And she did. Or at least I thought she did.

A few days later, Sophia wouldn't even look at me or respond to my messages. It felt like I had done something wrong, but no one would tell me what it was. Then I found out Sam told her everything I said. Not just that, but my words had been twisted, out of context. Sophia stopped talking to me completely after that.

The silence forced me realize that I had been trusting people too quickly just because we were close in proximity. Living together and spending a lot of time together made it feel like we had a deeper connection than we actually did. I've learned to be more careful about who I trust, and that I just need to be more aware of how quickly I open up to people, because trust takes time.



i hate ai i hate the government i hate the dollar i hate finance i hate the ideology behind liberal market economies i hate hate hate my phone and i hate everything on it i hate instagram reels i hate the time i waste doomscrolling, even if i occasionally learn something, i hate modern cars i hate that they all look like ice vehicles i hate electric scooters and you look lame on your electric skateboard i hate overhead lighting i hate all the screens surrounding me i hate the thin ass fabric on sixty dollar jeans i hate spending money if it's not an absolute need i hate overconsumption i hate that everything exists already i hate the world as it stands and it pisses me off all the time i'm filled with hatred to the top of my hat I HATE I HATE I HATE ¡pero! at the end of the day when i'm walking home i' can't help but love everything, i love the world i love my surroundings i love the grass i love the trees i love the pebbles at my feet i love the clouds i love the sky, starless as it might be, i love donkeys i love raccoons i love my cat and I love yours too i love the cigarette butts on the ground i love the donkey shit that's around i love it all i love it all

the WORLD FUCKIN SUCKS!

AS I CONTINUE TO EXIST IN THE WORLD I COME TO LEARN THIS OVER AND OVER AGAIN, FROM A THOUSAND DIFFERENT SOURCES BUT ALWAYS THE SAME WAYS. GREED, GREED, GREED, DISTORTING MINDS SINCE HUMANS BEGAN TO EXIST, WE ARE LIVING NOW IN THE ZENITH OF IT. IT'S IN THE WAY WE EAT, THE WAY WE SLEEP, THE WAY WE THINK, THE WAY WE BREATHE, THE WAY WE AND INTERACT WITH EACH OTHER. EVERYTHING EVERYWHERE IS ALWAYS ABOUT MONEY, ONE WAY OR ANOTHER. EVERYTHING ALWAYS COME BACK TO OBTAINING CAPITAL. EVERYTHING IS CONSTANTLY IN MOTION, ALLEGEDLY ADVANCING TOWARDS AN ULTIMATE GOAL, WHATEVER THAT IS I REALLY DON'T KNOW. TO ME IT SEEMS LIKE PROGRESS TO THE POINT OF REGRESSING THE MIND, THERE'S NO WAY WE NEED ALL THIS FUCKING CRAP. AT MY ADVANCED AGE OF 20 I RECALL A TIME BEFORE THE END OF THE WORLD, BUT AT MY MERE 20 YEARS OF AGE I'VE NOT MUCH EXPERIENCE WITH THE CYCLICAL NATURE OF HUMANITY, THERE'S NEVER BEEN A BEFORE, THE WORLD'S BEEN ENDING IN PERPETUITY SINCE IT WUZ BORN, MUCH LIKE YOU AND MYSELF. I HAVE NO CLUE AS TO WHAT WILL HAPPEN NEXT. I DON'T KNOW ANYTHING, HELP!!! i am so scared of the world!!! this world that is not meant for the vast majority to enjoy!! this world that has been corrupted by the stupid few!! stupid men, playing their stupid rules, stupidly created to benefit themselves and torture everyone else; crafting system after system to trap the people, cheating their way through life, extracting everything they can, only focusing on the now. man, it suuuuuucks, to be a part of a world filled with evil, complicit since birth and shaped entirely by it, *if only we had the collective power of the people to do something about this.....*

bye:P





THE PART WHERE EVERYTHING GETS QUIET



People always say you'll finally understand who you are once you get to college. Like turning 18 flips a switch and suddenly everything makes sense. You get freedom, independence, and the chance to build your own life. And to a certain extent, that's true. Nobody is going to stop me from buying a mini fridge just to hold a 36-pack of Diet Coke, but nobody really talks about the other side of it. The part where everything gets quiet and you do your damndest to fill in that silence.

My first quarter at UCR was honestly one of the worst times in my short life. I was alone for the first time ever. I never spoke unless prompted to. If I were to add it up, I probably uttered around four unprompted words that quarter. My routine was the same every single day; wake up, go to class, go to work, or sometimes go to the MMA gym, then go home. That was it. No conversations, no real meaningful interactions, nothing. Ten weeks went by like that, and it sure did not feel like 10 weeks. The silence wasn't peaceful either, it was just heavy. It made everything feel worse. In that silence you really only have 1 person there keeping you company, I got into my head and I was prescribed antidepressants for major depressive disorder. What got to me the most was that I was actually trying. I'm not an antisocial person at all. I've always been someone who likes being around people. So I tried talking to people in class, I tried putting myself out there, I even tried joining the MMA club thinking that would help. It just didn't work out the way I thought it would. Most of the people there were older or already knew each other, and it felt like I was just there, not really part of anything. Every time I tried to talk, it felt like people weren't really interested, like I was just bothering them. After a while, that starts to mess with you. You start thinking maybe it's you. Eight months ago, I was around my friends every day. People I've known for years. I didn't have to think twice about talking or being myself. Now I was in a place where I was practicing over and over on how to ask someone their name. That's a crazy switch to go through in such a short time. I couldn't really talk about it at home either. Whenever I tried to explain how I was feeling, it felt like it just got turned into something that was my fault, like I wasn't trying hard enough to get out there.

Things started to change during my second quarter when I met a group of people who seemed different at first. They were outgoing, they talked to me, and they invited me to go to a hardcore show with them. That was the first time in a while I actually felt included in something. I thought I finally found people I could be around. They were into drinking, smoking, and using drugs, which is something I've never really had a healthy relationship with. But at the time, I convinced myself it would be different. I told myself I could handle it this time, that I could find some kind of balance and just enjoy being there with people. Looking back, I think I just didn't want to feel alone anymore, and I was willing to ignore a lot just to have that.

After going to a few shows with them, I started to trust them more. I started doing the same things they were doing. Mixing that with my antidepressants and everything else, I was just trying to find some kind of "sweet spot" where I could feel good and not overthink everything. But I wasn't in control like I thought I was. One night, I went to a show with one of my friends who had never been to something like that before. We stayed on the outside of the pit, because that's usually where it's safe. Out of nowhere, this big guy, probably double my friend's size, spun around and kicked him straight in the back. Seeing that just flipped a switch in me. I was already not in the right state of mind, and I got angry fast. At the time, it felt justified. I wasn't really thinking, I just reacted. I went after the guy and started a fight over it. I don't even know if he meant to do it, but at that moment, it didn't matter to me. Instead of trying to calm me down or stop it, my friends were pushing me into it. They knew I had issues with anger, they knew I had been in therapy for it, but they still encouraged it. It felt like they just wanted to see what would happen. When everything got out of control and the cops were called, they all upped and left. Just like that. I was alone at a show in Anaheim. I ran until I ended up at a bus stop, sitting alongside a homeless man. He didn't say anything, just smiled at me. I had to call my parents to come pick me up at two in the morning, four cities away.



After that, I had to really think about what I was doing. I had to decide if I would rather be alone or keep being around people who were clearly making my life worse. I stayed around them because it was easier than being alone. But after that night, I realized that kind of "friendship" wasn't worth it. Going into my third quarter, I started trying to change things. I focused more on my job, my classes, and just getting myself back on track. I retook a class, and actually understood it better. More than that though, I'm starting to learn how to respect myself a little more. Not putting myself in situations I know aren't good for me, and not sticking around people just because I don't want to be alone. I'm still working on respecting myself, but I think things are starting to get a little better. I'm starting to understand that being an adult isn't just about having freedom. It's about learning how to handle being on your own, making mistakes, and figuring out who you actually want to be around. I'm not where I want to be yet, but I'm trying to get there.